

I Went From Drug Dealer to Millionaire Using These 3 Rules

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 28, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S1cBVsum2GY> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, speaking at Jason Capital's High Status event, recounts quitting cocaine dealing after his father's suicide and a friend's murder, then outlines his 'Champion Trifecta' — Goals, Discipline, and Energy — as the foundation for building a seven-figure business.

Contents

-  Opening & Context
-  Background: Drug Dealing & the Breaking Point
-  The Champion Trifecta Overview
-  Pillar 1: Goals
-  Pillar 2: Discipline
-  Pillar 3: Energy
-  Closing Argument

Opening & Context 0:00

- Brandon Carter is speaking at a Jason Capital event called "High Status"
- He introduces his core teaching: showing people "the fastest way to accomplish all your goals"
- He frames success as making "lots and lots of money" and achieving personal freedom
 - Audience definitions of freedom offered: doing whatever you want, never being employed by someone else, shopping without looking at price tags
- He teaches fitness entrepreneurs how to scale online; his students post "cha-ching" in his group chat when they make sales
- Core business philosophy mentioned early: **one strong core offer**, not 18 different products
- The presentation clicker malfunctions throughout, so most content is delivered from memory

Background: Drug Dealing & the Breaking Point 1:26

- Before building his business, Carter was a personal trainer in New York struggling to make money
 - Tried training more clients — hit a ceiling because there are only so many hours in a day
 - Tried raising prices; landed a few NFL clients but still not enough income

- Decided to start selling cocaine — flew to Miami, took Greyhound or Peter Pan bus back to New York with a bag of cocaine and distributed it for profit
 - Describes it as "lucrative" — "the stuff rappers talk about, I was really doing that"
 - Notes the statute of limitations has passed
- **The breaking point — three converging events:**
 - Friend "Esco" was found in New Jersey, car shot up, murdered
 - Friend "SV" was arrested and is serving a life sentence
 - His father — his best friend and idol, raised on the Southside of Chicago — went missing; a suicide note was found
 - Carter flew back to Chicago immediately
 - Chicago Police Department came to the door; his father had checked into a hotel two blocks from the house and shot himself in the head
- In that moment Carter felt two simultaneous emotions: deep despair and a sudden weight of responsibility
 - "I'm the man of the house now. Everyone's going to be dependent on me."
- Recognized a pattern: everyone around him involved in that lifestyle was either dead or in prison
 - "You become like the people you're around"
- Sold off remaining product and stopped dealing entirely
- Went back to working as a personal trainer but pushed hard to move the business online
 - Mentor **Elliot Host** (also Jason Capital's first mentor) introduced him to the online game
 - Found his "one core offer" online — that was the turning point
- **Current status:** seven-figure business, ~15 employees, penthouse office in Manhattan at 72nd and Broadway on the Upper West Side

The Champion Trifecta Overview 5:01

- Carter calls his framework the **"Champion Trifecta"** — three interlocking elements:
 - Goals
 - Discipline
 - Energy
- Each element has three sub-components
- When all three are operating at a "10," he argues it becomes "almost impossible to fail"
- Analogy used: Goals = the GPS destination; Discipline = a high-performance Lamborghini; Energy = the fuel — without fuel, nothing moves
- Positions this as the *foundation* beneath tactical skills like copywriting or Facebook ads: "Nothing really works without that"

Pillar 1: Goals 6:46

- **Sub-component 1 — Clear Destination**

- Not vague ("I want to be rich") — must be specific enough that a child can judge whether you achieved it or not
- Example of a good goal: "I want to make \$10,000 a month in my business by June 2019"
- Audience member example: "\$84,000 a month by December" — Carter calls this exactly right

- **Sub-component 2 — Detailed Plan**

- Write down *everything* you think you need to do to accomplish the goal
- Getting more sophisticated than just having a destination

- **Sub-component 3 — Deadline for Every Step**

- Not just a final deadline — put a deadline on each individual step of the plan, in order
- Carter describes this as the level that "takes it to another level" of sophistication
- Sequence matters: clear goal → detailed plan → deadline per step

Pillar 2: Discipline 16:32

- **Sub-component 1 — Do What You're Supposed to Do Whether You Feel Like It or Not**

- Explicitly rejects motivation as a reliable force: "You don't need motivation"
- Motivation = excitement/pumped-up feeling; it is inconsistent because humans feel the full range of emotions
- Discipline means the work gets done regardless of emotional state — "really fuck how you feel"

- **Sub-component 2 — Sacrifice**

- It took Carter **two years** of grinding before he felt he was doing really well and could quit his job
- During those two years: no TV, no movies, no parties, no barbecues
- Applied to fitness: giving up snacks, cookies, candy, etc.
- References a conversation with an imagined future version of himself (inspired by the Napoleon Hill / *Think and Grow Rich* "council" technique)
 - Future-self asked: "What percentage of your potential do you want?" — Carter said 100%
 - Future-self replied: "You know what that's going to cost you, right?"
 - Carter's conclusion: accept the cost or accept not living up to your potential
- "Most people in here aren't really willing to give up the things they need to give up to accomplish a goal"

- **Sub-component 3 — Accountability**

- Keeping yourself accountable alone is sometimes not enough
- Need a coach, friend, or family member to hold you accountable
- Example: going to the gym when you don't want to because a friend is meeting you there
- A coach formalizes this and makes discipline easier (or at least more consistent)

Pillar 3: Energy 20:44

- Framed as the least-discussed element of achievement but critically important
- **Sub-component 1 — Health**
 - If you have the flu, cancer, or any serious health issue, you cannot crush your goals
 - Must protect and maintain physical health as a prerequisite to performance
 - Carter mentions he has 1,000+ fitness/health videos on YouTube
- **Sub-component 2 — Environment**
 - Both physical environment and the people around you
 - People example: dating or befriending someone whose life is chaotic causes that chaos to "seep into yours"
 - Sociological point: people in the same region share the same accent, dress, diet — you can't help but become more like those around you
 - His drug-dealing past attributed directly to his Southside Chicago environment: "That's what we do. That's what I knew."
 - His turnaround partially attributed to changing his circle — joining masterminds, spending time with successful peers like Jason Capital and other speakers
 - Physical environment example — Carter's 4:30 AM wake-up system:
 - Sets phone alarm across the room so he physically must get up to turn it off (prevents hitting snooze)
 - The night before, mixes his pre-workout supplement **Rebellion** (made by his company **Bro Laboratories**) and places it next to the phone
 - Wakes up, crawls across the room, drinks the pre-workout off the floor
 - Pre-workout is placed right next to the bathroom — by the time he urinates, the supplement kicks in and he's ready to go
 - Key principle: **set your environment the night before** so momentum carries you in the morning
- **Sub-component 3 — Mindset**
 - If you are depressed or mentally down, it is very difficult to pursue your goals
 - Carter acknowledges personal experience with depression, suggests it may be hereditary given his father's history
 - "Things can get dark, and if you don't mind that, things can go off the rails"
 - A focused, positive mindset is the third energy lever

Closing Argument 28:04

- When all three pillars are operating at maximum:
 - Clear destination + deadlines for every step
 - Doing the work regardless of feelings + accountability partner
 - Perfect health + success-oriented environment + focused mindset
- "It'd be kind of hard to fail."

- Tactical skills (copywriting, Facebook ads, etc.) are valuable, but the Trifecta is the *foundation* — "nothing really works without that"
- Closes by asking the audience to follow him on Instagram: **King Keto** (handle: KINKETO / KINGKETO)
- Promises: "If you have all these things, I promise you, you will succeed."